by 2008. Likewise, average pensions increased from 823 rubles ($33) to 3500 rubles ($140) (ibid.).

It was not merely Putin who gave the Russian foreign policies a u-turn, but several other factors and indicators. After Putin was made President of the new Russian Federation, a distinct ‘integrationist’ trend emerged, with more collaborative communication with the United States and other Western institutions. Then, decisive efforts were made by Putin to bring normal relations with the West and even reached a new level. Russia allowed the US military presence in Central Asia to support the anti-Taliban operation in Afghanistan. Putin was the first to call Bush after the 9/11 incident (Ivano 2011) and express his solidarity. However, the scene had changed drastically with the United States's diabolical policies leading west toward Russian geostrategic territorial areas in Russia's post-Soviet space.

Growing Assertiveness of Russian Foreign Policy

Despite such efforts from Moscow, NATO continued with its geographic enlargement attempts, despite persistent objections from the Russian federation. Further, the United States unilaterally withdrew from the Soviet-US ABM Treaty in 2002. It means that the United States was still trying to undermine Russia through a system of strategic balance between Moscow and Washington (Ivano 2011). Here, Putin had to redesign his foreign policy objectives and become more assertive and pragmatic. During the famous Munich International Security conference in 2007 on February 12, Putin criticized the US foreign policy by remembering Franklin D. Roosevelt's words before World War II, when he emphatically mentioned that.

> Peace has broken everywhere. The peace of all countries everywhere is in danger. (Putin 2007)[11]

These words prevailed to be contextually significant in present-day world politics. The Munich Conference in 2007 on Security Policy was the clear-cut division between Russia and the West, where Putin lashed out at the West's diabolic attitude toward Russia. The remarks he made mentioned here: